KasSigner
Complete User Guide

Air-gapped Offline Signing Device for Kaspa

WARNING: KasSigner is an open-source offline signing device. You are the sole guardian of your keys. No company, no server, no device stores them for you. Manage your funds with care, verify every transaction on screen, and protect your seed phrase as you would protect your sovereignty.

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1. What KasSigner Is (and Is Not)

KasSigner is an open-source offline signing device built on the ESP32-S3. It generates private keys, signs Kaspa transactions via QR code exchange, and never connects to any network. All key material lives in RAM only and is destroyed on power-off.

What KasSigner IS:

- An offline signing device — generates keys, signs transactions, exports via QR
- A seed generator — BIP39 mnemonics from hardware entropy or dice rolls
- A steganographic backup tool — hides encrypted seeds inside JPEG photos
- Stateless — all key material in RAM, destroyed on power-off
- Open source — 100% Rust, reproducible Docker builds

What KasSigner is NOT:

- NOT a hardware wallet — no secure element, no tamper detection, no persistent storage
- NOT audited — no professional security review yet
- NOT resistant to physical attacks — JTAG, voltage glitching, flash readers
- NOT long-term key storage — your backup IS your storage, not the device

2. Supported Hardware

Why the ESP32-S3?

The ESP32-S3 is a dual-core 240MHz microcontroller with 512KB SRAM, 8MB PSRAM, and built-in USB. It runs bare-metal Rust with no operating system, no network stack, and no background processes. There is nothing between your keys and the silicon. The chip is inexpensive, widely available, and supported by a mature Rust toolchain. Its LCD_CAM peripheral provides native DVP camera input for QR scanning without external ICs. Two I2C buses, SPI, and SDHOST give direct access to display, touch, camera, and SD card — all controlled register-by-register in our code, with no vendor libraries or binary blobs in the signing path.

	Waveshare ESP32-S3-Touch-LCD-2	**M5Stack CoreS3 / CoreS3 Lite**
Price	~$25	~$45
Display	ST7789T3 320×240	ILI9342C 320×240
Camera	OV2640 / OV5640 DVP (auto-detect at boot)	GC0308 QVGA
Touch	CST816D capacitive	FT6336U capacitive
SD Card	SDHOST native (fast)	Bitbang SPI
Audio	—	AW88298 speaker
PSRAM	8MB octal	8MB octal

Waveshare pin map:

```
Camera: XCLK=8 PCLK=9 VSYNC=6 HREF=4 D0-D7=12,13,15,11,14,10,7,2
Camera I2C1: SDA=21 SCL=16 PWDN=17
Display SPI: MOSI=38 SCLK=39 CS=45 DC=42 RST=0 BL=1
Touch I2C0: SDA=48 SCL=47 INT=46
SD SDHOST: CLK=39 CMD=38 D0=40 | Battery: ADC=GPIO5
```

M5Stack CoreS3 pin map:

```
Camera: XCLK=2 PCLK=13 VSYNC=42 HREF=41 D0-D7=15,16,48,12,10,40,39,11
Display SPI2: MOSI=37 SCLK=36 CS=3 DC=35
Touch I2C0: SDA=12 SCL=11 INT=21
SD SPI: MOSI=37 SCLK=36 CS=4 (bitbang, shared bus)
PMU: AXP2101+AW9523B I2C0 | Speaker: AW88298 I2S
```

3. Installing the Build Toolchain

Step 1: Install Rust

```
curl --proto '=https' --tlsv1.2 -sSf https://sh.rustup.rs | sh
source ~/.cargo/env
```

Step 2: Install espup (Xtensa toolchain)

```
cargo install espup
espup install
```

Step 3: Install espflash

```
cargo install espflash
```

Step 4: Clone and verify

```
git clone https://github.com/InKasWeRust/KasSigner.git
cd KasSigner/tools
cargo run --bin kassigner-setup
```

The setup checker verifies Rust, espup, Xtensa toolchain, espflash, Docker, and serial ports. It shows exact install commands for anything missing.

4. Building and Flashing

Step 1: Connect board via USB-C and verify serial port

```
# macOS:
ls /dev/cu.usbmodem*

# Linux:
ls /dev/ttyUSB* /dev/ttyACM*
```

Step 2: Build and flash

Waveshare (default, OV5640):

```
cd bootloader
ESP_HAL_CONFIG_PSRAM_MODE=octal cargo run --release --features skip-tests
```

Waveshare (OV2640 wide-angle):

```
cd bootloader
ESP_HAL_CONFIG_PSRAM_MODE=octal cargo run --release --features skip-tests,ov2640-wide
```

M5Stack:

```
cd bootloader
cargo run --release --no-default-features --features m5stack
```

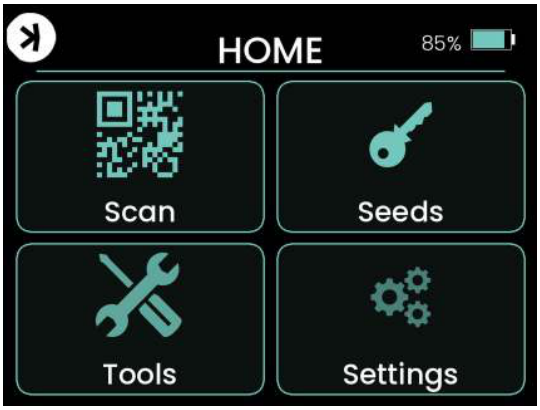
First build takes ~2-3 minutes (compiles all dependencies). Subsequent builds take ~5-10 seconds. The device reboots automatically after flashing and shows the home screen.

> To skip hardware self-tests for faster iteration, add --features skip-tests to your build command.

5. The Home Screen

After boot, KasSigner shows a 2×2 grid with four main areas:

- **Scan** — scan QR codes (KSPT, PSKT/PSKB, SeedQR, pubkeys for multisig)
- **Seeds** — manage seed slots, view addresses, export keys
- **Tools** — create seeds, import keys, BIP85, multisig, stego, message signing
- **Settings** — display brightness, camera, SD card, about screen



Tap any of the four cards to enter that section. The Kaspa logo and battery indicator are shown on the home screen only. Inside any menu, tap the top-left corner to go back.

6. Creating a New Wallet

From the home screen, tap Tools and then Seed Tools to access seed creation methods.

Method A: Camera Entropy

- Tap New Seed → choose 12 or 24 words
- Words generated from camera frame entropy + eFuse UID + SYSTIMER + timing jitter, mixed via SHA-256
- Words shown on screen — tap to advance

WARNING: Write down every word on paper. These words ARE your wallet. Do not photograph. Do not type into any internet-connected device.

Method B: Dice Rolls (verifiable entropy)

- Tap Dice Seed → choose 12 or 24 → roll a physical dice 99 or 198 times
- Tap the dice face (1-6) after each roll. Fully verifiable — same rolls produce the same mnemonic in any BIP39 tool

Method C: Calculate Last Word

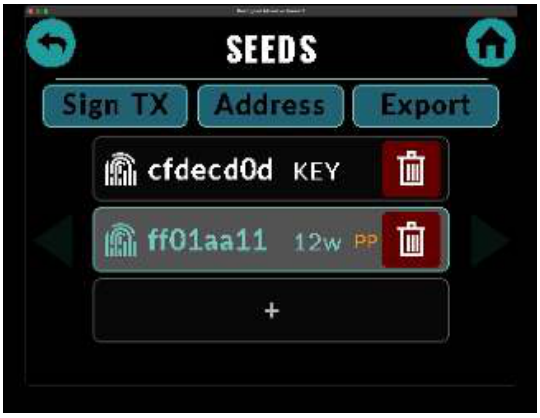
- Tap Calc Last Word → enter the first 11 or 23 words → device computes the valid checksum word

BIP39 Passphrase (25th word)

After seed creation, you can add an optional passphrase. This creates a hidden wallet: the 12/24 words alone lead to a decoy wallet, while words + passphrase lead to the real wallet. Keep your passphrase safe — it is never stored on the device.

7. Seed Management (Multi-Slot)

KasSigner holds up to 16 seed slots in RAM. Nothing is persisted — all slots are lost on power-off.



- Each slot shows a fingerprint hex code, the slot type (KEY, 12w, 24w), and PP if a passphrase is active
- The active slot is highlighted in teal — this is the one used for signing and address display
- Tap any slot to activate it
- Red trash icon securely zeroizes and removes a slot from RAM
- Empty + slot: tap to go to Tools for seed creation or import
- Two action buttons at the top: Address, Export — these operate on the active slot

Slot types:

- **Mnemonic (12w / 24w)** — full capabilities: derive addresses, sign, BIP85, SeedQR, kpub, xprv
- **XPrv** — account-level key: derive addresses, sign, kpub. No BIP85 or SeedQR
- **Raw Key (KEY)** — single address only: sign with one key, no derivation tree

8. Addresses and Keys

Derivation Paths

KasSigner uses BIP-44 derivation for Kaspa:

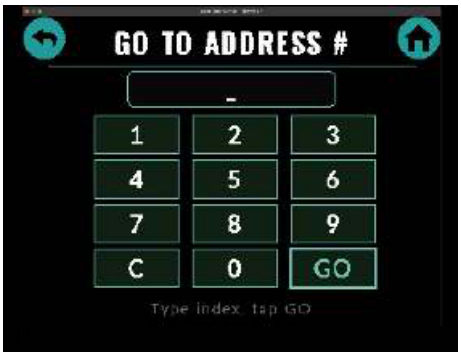
- **Receive:** m/44'/111111'/0'/0/N — addresses you share to receive funds
- **Change:** m/44'/111111'/0'/1/N — internal addresses for transaction change outputs

The first 20 receive addresses and 5 change addresses are pre-cached when a seed is loaded. Higher indices are derived on demand.

Viewing Addresses

From the Seeds screen, tap Address to see the receive address for the active seed at index #0.

- Tap the address text to display it as a full-screen QR code
- Use the < and > buttons to navigate between address indices
- Tap the #N button to jump to a specific index using the numeric keypad
- Tap the RECEIVE / CHANGE toggle (center button) to switch between receive and change address views
- Raw Key (KEY) slots show a single address with no navigation — they have no derivation tree



Private Key Export

From the Export menu under Signing Keys, tap Private Key:

- Enter the receive address index (#N) using the numeric keypad
- The device derives the private key for m/44'/111111'/0'/0/N and displays it as a hex QR code
- Tap anywhere to zeroize the key from memory and return to the menu

> **WARNING:** The private key gives full control of that single address. Export only to air-gapped devices. Never photograph it or expose it to a networked device.

Exporting Keys

From the Seeds screen, tap Export to open the Export menu:

- **Seed Backup** — Show Seed Words, QR Export (CompactSeedQR / Standard SeedQR / Plain Text QR), Backup to SD (encrypted)
- **Watch-Only** — kpub as QR, kpub to SD
- **Signing Keys** — xprv Account (Show as QR / Encrypt to SD), Private Key
- **Steganography** — hide your seed inside a JPEG photo on SD card

> The kpub allows viewing all addresses and balances but CANNOT sign transactions. Safe to import into an internet-connected companion wallet for building transactions.

9. Signing a Transaction (KSPT)

Why KSPT?

Kaspa's native transaction format is PSKT (Partially Signed Kaspa Transaction), a JSON structure with hex-encoded fields. While universal and used across the ecosystem, PSKT is verbose — a simple 1-input, 2-output transaction produces over 2,000 bytes of JSON, requiring multiple QR frames to scan across an air gap.

KasSigner uses KSPT (KasSigner Packed Transaction), a compact binary format designed specifically for air-gapped QR transport. KSPT strips JSON overhead and encodes values as raw bytes, producing significantly smaller payloads. A transaction that needs multiple QR frames in PSKT often fits in a single QR with KSPT.

For multisig signing, KasSigner also supports PSKT and PSKB (Partially Signed Kaspa Bundle) natively — the standard formats defined in the Kaspa KIP for M-of-N signing ceremonies.

KSPT is not a Kaspa standard — it is a KasSigner-specific format understood by the device and its companion app KasSee. KasSee translates between the Kaspa network's native PSKT format and KSPT for QR transport.

Air-gapped signing workflow

The device never connects to any network — data exchange happens via QR codes or SD card.

> Before signing, make sure you have loaded a seed or imported a key into a slot. Without an active seed, the signing process will fail.

1. KasSee builds an unsigned transaction and displays it as a QR code (KSPT for single-sig, PSKT/PSKB for multisig).
2. KasSigner scans the QR, parses the transaction, and shows a review screen.
3. You verify the destination, amount, change, and fee on the device screen.
4. The device signs and displays the signed transaction as a QR.
5. KasSee scans the signed QR and broadcasts to the Kaspa network.

Scan the transaction

From the home screen, tap Scan. Point the camera at the QR code displayed by KasSee. For multi-frame QR codes, hold steady — the device detects and decodes each frame automatically.

If the transaction has too many inputs (more than 8), the device shows "Too many UTXOs — Consolidate first" and returns to the main menu. Use KasSee's UTXO consolidation feature to reduce the number of inputs before retrying.

Format	1in/2out	Frames	3in/4out	Frames	QR prefix
Standard PSKB hex(JSON), all fields	2,016 B	9	4,512 B	19	PSKB
Opt 2: raw JSON strip nulls, no hex	675 B	3	1,503 B	7	PSKB
Opt 3: compressed strip + zlib + binary QR	330 B	2	338 B	2	PSKZ
Opt 1: KSPT binary custom compact format	161 B	1	361 B	2	KSPT

Opt 1: KSPT binary

+ Smallest payload (1 QR simple)
+ Device already parses it
+ Zero firmware changes
+ Instant scan, best UX

– Custom format, only KasSigner
– Two formats to maintain
– No covenants/DarkNight support
– Must sync if PSKB evolves

Opt 2: raw JSON

+ Standard PSKB JSON inside
+ No extra dependencies
+ Any PSKB parser reads it
+ Simple implementation

– 3 frames simple, 7 complex
– JSON parser needed on ESP32
– Scales poorly with inputs
– Verbose field names waste bytes

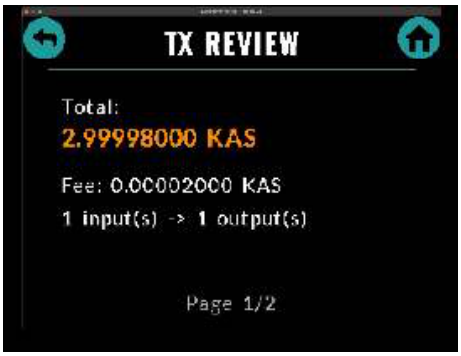
Opt 3: compressed

+ 2 frames even for complex TX
+ Standard PSKB after decompress
+ Future-proof (covenants++)
+ Scales perfectly (repetitive JSON)

– Adds miniz_oxide (~15KB flash)
– Custom PSKZ prefix
– More processing on device
– Can't eyeball compressed data

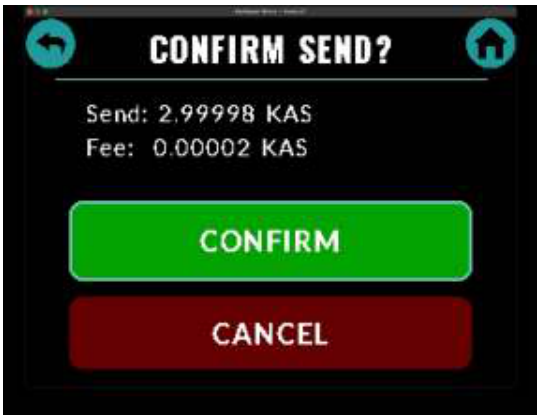
Review the transaction

The device shows total amount, change, fee, number of inputs/outputs, and the destination address for each output.



Confirm or cancel

Tap CONFIRM to sign or CANCEL to abort.



Signing

The device derives the correct private key for each input (searching both receive and change chains), computes the sighash using keyed Blake2b-256, and signs with Schnorr. For multi-input transactions, ~3

seconds per input.

Export signed transaction

The device displays the signed transaction as a QR code.

Broadcast

In KasSee, scan the signed QR to broadcast to the Kaspa network.

> The first air-gapped hardware-signed Kaspa transaction was broadcast on mainnet on March 30, 2026 using KasSigner. TX ID: 2faa58b247d8bf5b8f8d3d2a467b6821738e083ff7fcad06dfeffb09c520046d

Transaction size limits

The current signed transaction buffer is 1024 bytes, supporting up to 8 inputs per transaction.

If the transaction exceeds the limit, the device shows "Too many inputs — Consolidate UTXOs first". Use KasSee's UTXO selection to pick up to 8 UTXOs when sending, or consolidate them in batches first.

10. Signing Messages

KasSigner can sign arbitrary text messages with any address key. This proves you control an address without making a transaction.

How it works

From the Tools menu, tap Single Signature → Sign Message.

- Choose Type manually to enter text using the on-screen keyboard
- Or choose Load .TXT from SD to sign the contents of a text file on SD card

The device hashes the message with SHA-256 and signs the hash with Schnorr using the active address key. The result is displayed as a QR code containing:

- The original message text
- The Kaspa address that signed it
- The 64-byte Schnorr signature

Anyone can verify the signature against the address to confirm the signer controls the private key behind that address.

11. Multisig (M-of-N)

KasSigner supports M-of-N multisig addresses. Multiple co-signers each contribute a public key, and M of the N keys must sign to spend funds.

Creating a multisig address

From the Tools menu, tap Multisig → Create Multisig. Set M (required signatures) and N (total keys) using the +/– buttons, then tap NEXT.

For each key position, choose Scan kpub QR (scan another signer's public key) or Use Loaded Seed (use a seed already in a slot).

When using a loaded seed, tap the slot you want to contribute as a key and choose the derivation address.

Multisig wallet address

After all N keys are added, the device derives and displays the multisig address. Tap the address for a full-screen QR. You can save the multisig address to SD card — the device prompts for a filename using the on-screen keyboard.

The descriptor screen shows all participating public keys and can be exported to SD card for backup. The descriptor file preserves the full M-of-N configuration, key order, and derivation paths needed to reconstruct the multisig address on another device.

KasSee Web fully supports P2SH multisig: create multisig addresses, build multisig spend transactions (PSKT/PSKB), relay between co-signers, and broadcast fully signed transactions.

12. BIP85 Child Mnemonics

BIP85 derives independent child mnemonics from a master seed. Each child is a complete wallet that cannot be linked back to the parent. Use this to create separate wallets for different purposes from one master backup.

From the Tools menu, tap Seed Tools → BIP85 Child. Choose 12 or 24 words. Set the child index (0, 1, 2, ...) using +/– buttons, then tap DERIVE. The child mnemonic is displayed word by word. Write each word down — tap for next.

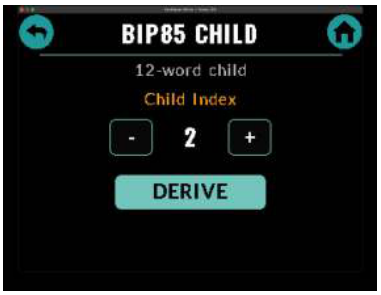
> Each index produces a different child. Index 0 always produces the same child from the same master. Write down the child words separately — they are a complete, independent wallet.

13. Backup: Encrypted SD Card

KasSigner can encrypt your seed words with AES-256-GCM and save them to a MicroSD card. The encryption key is derived from a password you choose via PBKDF2-HMAC-SHA512.

Creating a backup

- Insert a FAT32-formatted MicroSD card
- From the Seeds screen, tap Export → Seed Backup → Backup to SD
- Enter a password on the keyboard and tap OK
- The device encrypts and writes the backup file (progress bar shown)
- File is named with the seed fingerprint (e.g. SDC0B1)

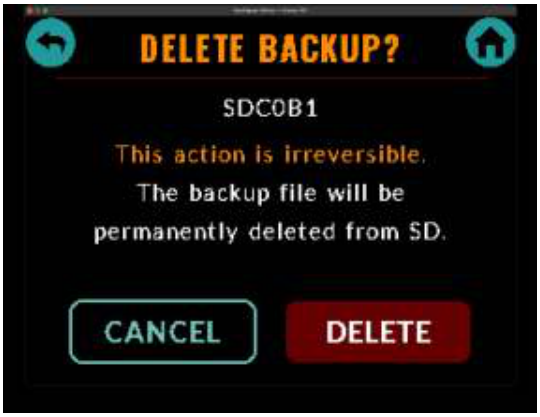


Restoring from backup

- From the Tools menu, tap Import / Export → Import from SD
- The device detects backup files and shows a file list
- Files matching a loaded seed show a label (e.g. "Seed #2")
- Tap a file, enter the password, and the seed is decrypted and loaded
- Progress bar: 0–80% PBKDF2 derivation, 90% decrypt, 100% loaded

Deleting a backup file

- Tap the red trash icon on a file card → confirmation screen
- CANCEL (teal outline, left) or DELETE (red, right)
- Tap DELETE → button changes to "HOLD 4s" → press and hold 4 seconds to confirm
- Release early or move finger off the button to cancel



WARNING: If you forget the password, the backup cannot be recovered. There is no reset mechanism. Keep your password safe.

14. Backup: Steganographic JPEG

KasSigner's steganographic backup hides your seed inside an ordinary JPEG photograph. Three layers of protection:

- **Layer 1 — Steganography:** The encrypted seed is stored in JPEG EXIF metadata. The image looks ordinary. Nobody knows which file matters.
- **Layer 2 — Encryption:** The seed is encrypted with AES-256-GCM. The key is derived via PBKDF2 from the image descriptor text you enter.
- **Layer 3 — BIP39 passphrase:** Even if decrypted, the 24 words alone lead to a decoy wallet. The real wallet lives behind a passphrase only in your memory.

Creating a stego backup

From Seeds → Export → Steganography. Select a JPEG from the SD card.

Enter or load the image descriptor — this text becomes the encryption key.

Optionally hide a recovery hint for your BIP39 passphrase inside the EXIF data. The answer to the hint IS your passphrase.

Confirm the overwrite — the original JPEG is modified in place with the encrypted seed embedded.

Restoring from stego backup

From the Tools menu, tap Import / Export → Stego Import.

Enter the exact image descriptor used during backup.

If a recovery hint was stored, the device shows it. The answer IS your BIP39 passphrase — enter it as the 25th word.

> **WARNING:** The descriptor must match exactly — including capitalization, spaces, and punctuation. There is no recovery mechanism if forgotten. For a deep dive into the cryptographic design, threat model, and why this approach works, read docs/STEGANOGRAPHY.md in the repository.

15. Backup: SeedQR (Paper)

SeedQR encodes your BIP39 mnemonic as a QR code that you print on paper or engrave on metal. It is a community-standard format compatible with SeedSigner, Krux, and other air-gapped devices.

KasSigner supports three SeedQR variants:

- **CompactSeedQR** — binary encoding of BIP39 word indices. Smallest QR, fastest scan. Recommended.
- **Standard SeedQR** — 4-digit zero-padded BIP39 indices. Compatible with SeedSigner.
- **Plain Words QR** — mnemonic words as plain text. Human-readable but largest QR.

Exporting a SeedQR

From Seeds → Export → Seed Backup → QR Export. Choose the format.

The device displays the QR on screen. Tap for the grid view to hand-copy the pattern onto paper.

Importing a SeedQR

From the home screen, tap Scan. Point the camera at any SeedQR (compact, standard, or plain). The device auto-detects the format, decodes the mnemonic, and loads it into a seed slot.

WARNING: SeedQR is unencrypted — anyone who sees or photographs the QR has your seed. Treat SeedQR backups with the same care as written seed words.

SeedQR only stores the mnemonic words. It does not include your BIP39 passphrase (25th word). Always use a passphrase for real security — the passphrase turns your seed into a completely different wallet that cannot be derived from the words alone.

16. Importing Seeds and Keys

KasSigner supports multiple import methods to load seeds and keys from external sources into a slot.

Import via QR scan

From the home screen, tap Scan. The device auto-detects the QR type:

- **CompactSeedQR** — loads 12 or 24 word mnemonic
- **Standard SeedQR** — 4-digit BIP39 indices
- **Plain Words QR** — space-separated mnemonic text
- **xprv QR** — account-level extended private key
- **kpub QR** — watch-only extended public key (for multisig)

Import words manually

From Tools → Seed Tools → Import Words. Enter each BIP39 word using the on-screen keyboard with autocomplete suggestions. After 12 or 24 words, the device validates the checksum and loads the seed.

Import from encrypted SD card

From Tools → Import / Export → Import from SD. See chapter 13 for details.

Import from steganographic JPEG

From Tools → Import / Export → Stego Import. See chapter 14 for details.

Import raw private key

From Tools → Import / Export → Import Raw Key. Enter a 32-byte hex private key via QR scan or the keyboard. This creates a single-address KEY slot — no derivation tree, just one address and one key.

> After any import, you are prompted for an optional BIP39 passphrase (25th word). This applies to mnemonic imports only — raw keys and xprv imports skip this step.

17. SD Card Management

KasSigner uses MicroSD cards for encrypted seed backups, steganographic JPEG backups, multisig descriptors, signed transactions, and text file loading. From Settings → SD Card you can check the card status, format it, or test read/write.

Requirements

- FAT32 format — the device reads/writes FAT32 only. exFAT and NTFS are not supported.
- MicroSD up to 32GB recommended. Larger cards may work if formatted as FAT32.
- Standard speed cards are fine — data volumes are small (backup files are under 1KB).

File types on SD

- **SDXXXX** — encrypted seed backup (AES-256-GCM). Named by fingerprint, no extension.
- **XPXXXX** — encrypted xprv account key. Named by fingerprint, no extension.
- **.KSP** — signed/unsigned KSPT transaction files. Can be saved encrypted (with password) or unencrypted.
- **.JPG** — JPEG photos (for stego backup). Device reads/writes EXIF metadata.
- **.TXT** — text files (for message signing, multisig addresses, or descriptor export).
- Multisig address files — saved with a user-chosen filename via the on-screen keyboard.
- Multisig descriptor files — exported to SD for backup of the full M-of-N configuration.

Troubleshooting

- SD not detected: Remove and reinsert. Ensure FAT32 format. Try a different card.
- File not showing: Filenames must be 8.3 format (uppercase, no long names).
- Write error: Check the card isn't write-protected (physical lock tab on adapter).

> The SD card is never required for basic operation. Seeds can be created, imported, and used for signing without an SD card. The card is only needed for encrypted backups, stego backups, and message signing from file.

18. Settings

From the home screen, tap Settings to access device configuration.

Display

Adjusts the LCD backlight level. Higher brightness improves QR scanning by the companion camera but draws more power from battery or USB.

Camera (Waveshare only)

The Settings → Camera screen provides real-time camera tuning with adjustable parameters: AEC (auto-exposure), contrast, brightness, AGC ceiling, and sharpness. Changes apply immediately via I2C. Useful for optimizing QR scanning in difficult lighting conditions.

Audio (M5Stack only)

Sound settings. Toggle confirmation beeps and adjust volume.

SD Card

Shows card status (detected/not detected, type, capacity). Provides Format FAT32 to wipe and reformat the card on-device, and Test R/W to verify read/write. See chapter 17 for details.

About

Shows firmware version, build hash, hardware target, and project information.

Firmware Verification at Boot

At every boot, KasSigner verifies the firmware's Schnorr signature against DEV_PUBKEY embedded in the source code. This is a software-level check independent of Secure Boot V2 (which is hardware-level RSA). If the signature is invalid or the firmware has been tampered with, the device displays a warning on the splash screen. Both layers — hardware RSA and software Schnorr — must pass for the firmware to run normally.

19. Camera and QR Tips

KasSigner decodes QR codes using rqrr, a no_std Rust fork of the rqrr 0.10.1 library. It supports QR versions V1 through V40, all four ECC levels, and includes full Reed-Solomon error correction with perspective transform. A single successful decode is accepted with no voting or multi-pass heuristics needed.

Camera hardware

The Waveshare board supports two sensors with runtime auto-detection: the OV2640 (wide-angle, 2MP) and OV5640 (5MP). The firmware probes the sensor ID at boot and configures the appropriate driver automatically. The Waveshare uses a DMA-based 480×480 YUV422 capture pipeline for QR decoding.

The M5Stack uses a GC0308 QVGA sensor with Y-only (grayscale) capture at 320×240, decoded from an SRAM buffer.

Lighting

- Bright, even lighting works best. Avoid shadows falling across the QR code.
- The screen displaying the QR should be at maximum brightness.
- Avoid direct sunlight hitting the camera lens — causes washout.

Distance and angle

- Hold the device 10–15 cm from the QR code for best focus.
- Keep the camera parallel to the QR — avoid extreme angles.
- For small QR codes (SeedQR), move closer. For large codes (multi-frame), pull back slightly.

Multi-frame QR codes

- KasSee displays animated QR frames that cycle automatically.
- Hold the camera steady — the device detects 0-based frame numbers and assembles them.
- Progress dots appear below the viewfinder: gray = pending, teal = received.
- If a frame is missed, just keep holding — the animation loops and the device catches up.
- The multi-frame buffer supports up to 40 frames (10KB total payload).

OV5640 thermal note (Waveshare)

The OV5640 sensor runs warm during continuous capture. After extended use (5+ minutes of scanning), image quality may degrade slightly. This is normal. The camera recovers after a brief rest.

> If the camera seems stuck or shows a frozen image, unplug USB, wait 10 seconds, and reconnect. This performs a full power cycle.

20. Key Derivation Architecture

KasSigner follows the BIP32/BIP39/BIP44 key derivation hierarchy used by Kaspa wallets. Understanding this tree is important for verifying that your addresses match between KasSigner and other Kaspa software.

Derivation path

```
m / purpose' / coin_type' / account' / change / index
m / 44' / 111111' / 0' / 0 / 0
```

- **purpose = 44'** — BIP44 standard
- **coin_type = 111111'** — Kaspa's registered coin type
- **account = 0'** — first account (hardened)
- **change = 0** — receive chain (external). Change chain = 1.
- **index = 0, 1, 2...** — sequential address index

Key levels

- **Master key (m)** — derived from BIP39 seed. Only exists with full mnemonic.
- **Account key (m/44'/111111'/0')** — this is the xprv level. Can derive all addresses and sign, but cannot derive BIP85 children.
- **Address key (m/.../0/N)** — individual receive address. Single secp256k1 keypair.
- **kpub** — the extended public key at account level. Derives all public addresses but cannot sign. This is what KasSee imports.

Change addresses

When a transaction doesn't spend the full UTXO, the remainder goes to a change address on the change chain (m/.../1/N). KasSigner searches both receive (chain 0) and change (chain 1) when signing, so it correctly signs inputs from either chain.

21. Security Model

KasSigner's security is based on air-gap isolation and ephemeral key storage. It is not a hardware wallet with a secure element — it is a signing device that makes deliberate tradeoffs.

What KasSigner protects against

- **Network attacks:** No WiFi, no Bluetooth, no radio. The ESP32-S3's radio is disabled in hardware (eFuse) when Secure Boot is enabled. There is no code path that initializes any wireless peripheral.
- **Malware on your computer:** The device never sends keys over USB. Data exchange happens only via QR codes and SD card. A compromised computer cannot extract keys.
- **Memory persistence:** All key material lives in SRAM only, destroyed on power-off. On panic, the firmware wipes the entire 512KB SRAM (two passes) before halting.
- **Supply chain (with Secure Boot):** Secure Boot V2 ensures only firmware signed with your key can run. See chapter 23.

What KasSigner does NOT protect against

- **Physical access attacks:** JTAG, voltage glitching, flash readers, cold boot attacks on SRAM. The ESP32-S3 has no tamper-detect hardware.
- **Side-channel attacks:** No constant-time guarantees on all cryptographic paths (though hash comparison uses constant-time). Power analysis and EM emanation attacks are possible.
- **Evil maid:** If someone swaps your device for a modified one, you wouldn't know (unless Secure Boot is enabled and you verify the firmware hash).
- **Firmware bugs:** The code has not been professionally audited.

Defense in depth

KasSigner's real security comes from layering multiple independent protections:

- **Air gap:** No network connection → no remote attack surface.
- **Ephemeral RAM:** Keys exist only while powered → no persistent key storage to attack.
- **BIP39 passphrase:** Even with the 24 words, the real wallet is behind a passphrase only in your head.
- **Steganographic backup:** Your seed backup looks like a photo. Nobody knows which file matters.
- **Open source:** Every line of code is auditable. No vendor libraries in the signing path.
- **Reproducible builds:** Docker builds produce bit-identical binaries. You can verify the firmware matches the source.
- **Secure Boot V2:** Only your signed firmware runs on the device.

Panic wipe

If the firmware encounters an unrecoverable error (panic), it immediately wipes the entire 512KB SRAM using two full passes of write_volatile before halting. This ensures no key material survives in memory after a crash, even if the device is powered and physically captured.

> **WARNING:** KasSigner has NOT been professionally audited. Use it with full awareness that bugs may exist. Your ultimate protection is the BIP39 passphrase — a secret that exists only in your memory and never touches any device.

22. Reproducible Builds (Docker)

KasSigner provides a Docker-based reproducible build system. Anyone can build the firmware from source and verify the binary matches the official release — bit for bit.

Step 1: Build the toolchain base image (once)

```
docker build --platform linux/amd64 -f Dockerfile.base -t kassigner-toolchain:v2 .
```

Step 2: Build the firmware (both platforms)

```
docker build --platform linux/amd64 -t kassigner-build .
```

Step 3: Verify

```
docker run --rm kassigner-build
```

Compare the SHA-256 hashes with the ones in the GitHub Release. If they match, the binary was built from the exact same source.

Why it works

- Forced x86_64 — identical hashes on Intel and Apple Silicon
- Pinned toolchain — exact Rust and espup versions frozen in base image
- Cargo.lock — every dependency pinned to exact version and hash
- SOURCE_DATE_EPOCH=0 — eliminates timestamps from the build
- objcopy — strips build-path metadata from final binary

> Reproducible builds let you verify that the firmware running on your device matches the public source code. Don't trust — verify.

23. Secure Boot (eFuse)

> **WARNING:** ALL eFuse operations are IRREVERSIBLE. A mistake can permanently brick the board. Read the full EFUSE_RUNBOOK.md in the docs/ folder before touching any commands. Test on a sacrificial board first.

KasSigner has two independent signature verification layers: hardware Secure Boot V2 (RSA-3072, verified by the silicon ROM) and a software Schnorr check (verified by our code). Both must pass for the firmware to run.

Step 0: Verify clean board

```
python3 -m espefuse --port /dev/cu.usbmodem* --chip esp32s3 summary
```

All security eFuses must be at default (False/0). Stop if any are already set.

Step 1: Generate RSA-3072 signing key

```
python3 -m espsecure generate_signing_key --version 2 \
--scheme rsa3072 secure_boot_v2_key.pem
```

Back this up to 3+ offline locations immediately. Losing this key bricks the board forever.

Step 2: Generate and burn key digest

```
python3 -m espsecure digest_sbv2_public_key \
--keyfile secure_boot_v2_key.pem --output digest0.bin

python3 -m espefuse --port /dev/cu.usbmodem* --chip esp32s3 \
burn_key BLOCK_KEY0 digest0.bin SECURE_BOOT_DIGEST0
```

Step 3: Revoke unused key slots

```
python3 -m espefuse --port /dev/cu.usbmodem* --chip esp32s3 burn_efuse
SECURE_BOOT_KEY_REVOKE1
python3 -m espefuse --port /dev/cu.usbmodem* --chip esp32s3 burn_efuse
SECURE_BOOT_KEY_REVOKE2
```

Step 4: Sign and flash BEFORE enabling secure boot

```
python3 -m espsecure sign_data --version 2 \
--keyfile secure_boot_v2_key.pem \
--output kassigner-signed.bin kassigner-waveshare.bin

python3 -m esptool --port /dev/cu.usbmodem* --baud 460800 \
write_flash 0x10000 kassigner-signed.bin
```

Verify it boots correctly before proceeding.

Step 5: Enable Secure Boot (point of no return)

```
python3 -m espefuse --port /dev/cu.usbmodem* --chip esp32s3 \
burn_efuse SECURE_BOOT_EN
```

After this, only firmware signed with your key will boot.

Step 6: Production lockdown (optional)

For maximum security, disable debug interfaces:

```
python3 -m espefuse --port /dev/cu.usbmodem* --chip esp32s3 burn_efuse DIS_PAD_JTAG
python3 -m espefuse --port /dev/cu.usbmodem* --chip esp32s3 burn_efuse DIS_USB_JTAG
python3 -m espefuse --port /dev/cu.usbmodem* --chip esp32s3 burn_efuse DIS_USB_SERIAL_JTAG
python3 -m espefuse --port /dev/cu.usbmodem* --chip esp32s3 burn_efuse DIS_DIRECT_BOOT
python3 -m espefuse --port /dev/cu.usbmodem* --chip esp32s3 burn_efuse
ENABLE_SECURITY_DOWNLOAD
```

WARNING: Do NOT burn DIS_DOWNLOAD_MODE unless absolutely sure — this permanently prevents any firmware update via UART. Since KasSigner has no OTA, this makes the board unupdatable.

What gets disabled

- **JTAG** — hardware debugging port permanently disabled
- **USB Serial/JTAG** — debug serial interface disabled
- **Direct boot** — forces ROM to always verify signatures
- **Unsigned firmware** — only signed binaries boot

Recovery

There is no recovery from a bricked eFuse configuration. If secure boot is enabled and the signing key is lost, the board is permanently bricked. Buy a new board.

The complete step-by-step process with pre-flight checklist, flash encryption options, eFuse budget table, and decision matrix is in docs/EFUSE_RUNBOOK.md.

24. Live Display Mirror

KasSigner can mirror its display to a computer in real-time over the USB-JTAG serial interface. This creates a window on your computer showing exactly what the device screen shows — useful for demos, screenshots, and troubleshooting. You need two terminal windows.

Terminal 1 — Flash and run the firmware:

```
cd bootloader
ESP_HAL_CONFIG_PSRAM_MODE=octal cargo run --release \
--features waveshare,mirror,skip-tests
```

Terminal 2 — Launch the mirror viewer:

```
cd tools
cargo run --release --bin kassigner-mirror -- /dev/cu.usbmodem21201
```

Replace /dev/cu.usbmodem21201 with your actual JTAG-serial port. A 960×720 window opens showing the device screen in real-time.

Features

- Real-time framebuffer streaming over JTAG-serial at ~15 fps
- 960×720 window using minifb (pure Rust, no SDL)
- Arrow key navigation from the computer keyboard
- PNG export with --export flag for automated screenshots

> The mirror is a development/demo tool. It does not transmit any key material — only pixel data flows over serial. The device operates identically with or without the mirror connected.

25. KasSee — Watch-Only Companion

KasSee is a browser-based watch-only companion wallet built in pure Rust compiled to WebAssembly. It runs entirely in your browser — no installation, no server, no backend. It holds only the extended public key (kpub) and can see your addresses and balances but cannot sign transactions.

Getting started

- Open KasSee at kassigner.org in any modern browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge)
- Import your kpub by scanning the QR code from KasSigner or pasting the hex string
- KasSee connects to a Kaspa node via WebSocket to fetch balances and UTXOs
- Installable as a PWA on mobile — add to home screen for app-like experience

Features

- Address derivation — derive receive and change addresses from the kpub
- Address reuse prevention — funded addresses show an orange "funded" badge, spent addresses show a gray "used" badge. Receive screen auto-skips to the first clean address.
- Explorer links — every address links to the Kaspa block explorer
- Balance tracking — real-time UTXO and balance display via Kaspa node
- Build transactions — create unsigned KSPT transactions with fee estimation (low / normal / priority)
- Send Max — sweep all UTXOs in a single transaction
- UTXO selection — manually select up to 8 UTXOs when sending to stay within the signer's input limit
- Broadcast — scan signed QR from KasSigner and submit to the network
- UTXO explorer — view all UTXOs with selectable checkboxes for consolidation
- UTXO consolidation — select up to 8 UTXOs and merge them into a single output. Repeat in batches.
- Address list — tap to verify, long-press to copy
- Address verification — display address QR + derivation path for on-device comparison
- P2SH multisig — create multisig addresses, build multisig spend transactions (PSKT/PSKB), relay between co-signers, broadcast fully signed transactions
- Token display — KRC-20 token balances, KRC-721 NFT listings, KNS domain names
- Camera scanner — scan QR codes directly from the browser (kpub, signed TX, descriptors)
- Animated QR — multi-frame QR display with pause/play control and frame indicator
- Custom node — connect to any Kaspa node via WebSocket in Settings
- Address history — optional used-address detection via self-hosted kaspa-rest-server
- Storage mass awareness — warns when balance is below 0.2 KAS (KIP-9/Crescendo)

Signing workflow

1. In KasSee, enter the destination address and amount, then tap Send
2. KasSee builds an unsigned KSPT and displays it as an animated QR
3. On KasSigner, tap Scan and point the camera at the QR
4. Review and confirm the transaction on the device
5. KasSigner displays the signed transaction as a QR
6. In KasSee, tap Broadcast and scan the signed QR from the device
7. KasSee submits the transaction to the Kaspa network

> KasSee never has access to private keys. It builds unsigned transactions that must be signed by KasSigner. All cryptography runs client-side in WebAssembly — nothing is sent to a server.

Donation

Tapping the KasSigner logo in the header shows a donation card with the project's Kaspa address and QR code. If a wallet is loaded, tapping the logo prefills the Send screen with the donation address instead.

26. Troubleshooting

Device won't boot / blank screen

- Unplug USB, wait 10 seconds, reconnect. This forces a full power cycle.
- Try a different USB cable — some cables are charge-only (no data).
- Hold the BOOT button while plugging in to enter ROM download mode, then reflash.

Camera frozen / no image

- Unplug USB, wait 10 seconds, reconnect for a full sensor power cycle.
- Check lighting — very dark environments may show a near-black image.
- On Waveshare, the firmware auto-detects OV2640 vs OV5640 at boot. If detection fails, power cycle.
- On M5Stack, the GC0308 is lower resolution. Move the QR closer to the camera.

QR not scanning

- Increase display brightness on the device showing the QR.
- Hold 10–15 cm from the QR, parallel to the screen.
- For multi-frame, hold steady and wait for all frames to cycle.
- Avoid reflections on glass screens — tilt slightly if needed.

SD card not detected

- Must be FAT32 format. Cards over 32GB need manual FAT32 formatting.
- Remove and reinsert firmly.
- Use Settings → SD Card → Format FAT32 to format on-device.
- Try a different MicroSD card.

Signing failed

- Make sure the correct seed is loaded and active (check fingerprint).
- The transaction must be addressed to keys derivable from the active seed.
- "Too many inputs" error — maximum is 8 inputs per transaction. Use KasSee's UTXO selection or consolidation to reduce inputs.

Wrong password on SD import

- The error message says "Wrong password" — re-enter carefully.
- Passwords are case-sensitive. Check exact capitalization.

Touch not responding

- KasSigner uses tap-on-lift (fires on finger release, not press). Tap and release cleanly.
- The CST816D (Waveshare) has tuned sensitivity to reject ghost touches from ambient light and EMI. A firm, deliberate tap is best.
- Avoid tapping with wet fingers or through screen protectors.

Build errors

- Run cargo run --bin kassigner-setup from the tools directory to check your environment.
- Ensure correct feature flags: default for Waveshare, --no-default-features --features m5stack for M5Stack.

LCD ghost image / burn-in

The ST7789T3 display retains charge from bright pixels (especially white QR code screens). This is not permanent burn-in — the firmware applies a gray wash sequence before camera init to discharge retained pixels. If ghosting persists, power cycle the device.

27. Command Reference

Firmware build commands

```
# Waveshare (default, OV5640):
cd bootloader
ESP_HAL_CONFIG_PSRAM_MODE=octal cargo run --release --features skip-tests

# Waveshare (OV2640 wide-angle):
cd bootloader
ESP_HAL_CONFIG_PSRAM_MODE=octal cargo run --release --features skip-tests,ov2640-wide

# M5Stack CoreS3:
cargo run --release --no-default-features --features m5stack
```

Clippy lint

```
ESP_HAL_CONFIG_PSRAM_MODE=octal cargo clippy --features waveshare,skip-tests
cargo clippy --no-default-features --features m5stack,skip-tests
```

Docker reproducible builds

```
docker build --platform linux/amd64 -f Dockerfile.base -t kassigner-toolchain:v2 .
docker build --platform linux/amd64 -t kassigner-build .
docker run --rm kassigner-build
```

One-step installer (macOS)

```
bash Install.sh
```

Mirror viewer (separate terminal)

```
cd tools && cargo run --release --bin kassigner-mirror -- /dev/cu.usbmodem21201
```

Environment check

```
cd tools && cargo run --bin kassigner-setup && cd ..
```

KasSee Web (WASM build)

```
cd kassee && RUSTUP_TOOLCHAIN=stable ./build.sh
```

This compiles the Rust source to WebAssembly and outputs the WASM + JS bindings to kassee/web/pkg/. Open kassee/web/index.html in a browser to use KasSee locally.

What happens when you power off? Everything is gone. Every key, every seed, every passphrase — wiped from RAM. The device boots fresh every time. Your wallet lives in your backup. The device is just the tool that brings the wallet to life temporarily, signs what needs signing, and then forgets.

KasSigner — An InKasWeRust Project

kassigner@proton.me | github.com/InKasWeRust/KasSigner